Research and caveats summary

DEMO-EH-1002 · *Prunus africana* · bark · status: Ready for authorised human review · **SYNTHETIC DEMO DATA**

Activity: bark stripping on managed quarters · Region: North-West Region, Cameroon (synthetic) · Jurisdiction: Cameroon · Exact site: —

A Harvest Passport is an internal evidence and traceability record. It is not a government permit, a FairWild certificate, a validated local harvest quota, or an assurance of legal compliance or product safety.

Species- and part-specific cautions

Status: ok

Published observational comparison (harvest not randomised) on bark harvest (supported-by-study; applies: same species, same part; review: awaiting expert review)

Mean long-term growth rate λ 0.999 in harvested populations vs 0.985 in the comparison populations (difference +0.015; 4 vs 1 matrices).

Next: Use it as a scenario in the Studio; local stage counts and recovery measurements are still needed before setting any limit.

Sources: Stewart KM (2001) The commercial bark harvest of the African cherry (Prunus africana) on Mount Oku, Cameroon (PhD thesis); matrices as archived in COMPADRE

How sensitive this population is to the harvested process (survival and growth of established plants) (computed-from-matrices; applies: this species; review: shown with caveats; awaiting expert review)

About 99% (95% range 98–100%) of this plant's long-run population growth depends on survival and growth of established plants, the process a bark harvest affects (16 published matrices, this species).

Next: Use this to judge which local measurements matter most (e.g. survival of large plants), not as a harvest limit.

Sources: COMPADRE v6.26.3.0 matrices (computed here)

With good and bad years mixed in (computed-from-matrices; applies: this species; review: computed; awaiting expert review)

Simulating 20,000 years that randomly draw from the published matrices, the harvested populations grows (λs 1.006) and the unharvested ones shrinks (λs 0.9845).

Next: Compare this with local monitoring before drawing conclusions.

Sources: COMPADRE v6.26.3.0 matrices (computed here)

1 paper on other species reports that harvest did not change growth. (ai-found-literature; applies: other species (transferability uncertain); review: needs expert review before use)

Found by the evidence agent: JEV classified the paper, Groq extracted the finding, and the quote below was checked word-for-word against the abstract.

Next: A scientific reviewer should read the paper(s) and confirm or reject this finding.

Sources: Functional traits partially mediate the effects of chronic anthropogenic disturbance on the growth of a tropical tree. (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/29991997)

Evidence from another species harvested for bark + foliage: Khaya senegalensis (transferred-from-other-species; applies: different species, same part; review: awaiting expert review)

Mean long-term growth rate λ 0.982 in harvested populations vs 1.008 in the comparison populations (difference -0.026; 6 vs 6 matrices).

Next: Look for a study on this species; until then monitor plots before and after harvest.

Sources: GAOUE OG, TICKTIN T (2010) Effects of Harvest of Nontimber Forest Products and Ecological Differences between Sites on the Demography of African Mahogany. Conservation Biology 24:605-614. doi:10.1111/j.1523-1739.2009.01345.x (https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1523-1739.2009.01345.x)

Evidence from another species harvested for bark + foliage: Khaya senegalensis (transferred-from-other-species; applies: different species, same part; review: awaiting expert review)

Mean long-term growth rate λ 0.975 in harvested populations vs 0.992 in the comparison populations (difference -0.017; 6 vs 6 matrices).

Next: Look for a study on this species; until then monitor plots before and after harvest.

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Sources: Gaoue OG, Horvitz CC, Ticktin T, Steiner UK, Tuljapurkar S (2013) Defoliation and bark harvesting affect life■history traits of a tropical tree. Journal of Ecology 101:1563-1571. doi:10.1111/1365-2745.12140 (https://doi.org/10.1111/1365-2745.12140)

CITES Appendix II listing (regulatory-listing; applies: same species; parts covered depend on the annotation; review: awaiting expert review)

International trade needs CITES documents issued by the exporting country's Management Authority. The listing does not govern collection itself.

Next: Before any cross-border shipment, confirm with the CITES Management Authority which documents apply to your product.

Sources: Species+ (CITES and CMS listings) (https://speciesplus.net/); CITES Appendices I, II and III (https://cites.org/eng/app/appendices.php)

Export quota and non-detriment finding (requires-authority-confirmation; applies: Cameroon, Prunus africana; review: awaiting expert review)

Bark exports are managed through CITES export quotas based on non-detriment findings and management inventories; quotas have changed over time following CITES reviews.

Next: Ask the CITES Management Authority (forestry ministry) for the current quota, the allocation for your area and the management unit's inventory status.

Sources: CITES Plants Committee PC16 Doc. 10.2: Review of Significant Trade (includes Prunus africana) (https://cites.org/sites/default/files/eng/com/pc/16/E-PC16-10-02.pdf); Critical study of guidance for a national Prunus africana management plan, Cameroon (2010) (https://www.itto.int/files/user/cites/cameroon/CRITICAL%20STUDY%20OF%20PRUNUS%20AFRICANA%20MANAGEMENT%20PLAN%20CAMEROON_Julius_28_11_2010.pdf); CITES Appendices I, II and III (https://cites.org/eng/app/appendices.php)

8 papers the AI could not classify confidently (needs-review; applies: search results; review: awaiting expert review)

JEV and the keyword rules disagreed, or JEV was unsure. They may or may not contain harvest effects.

Next: A scientific reviewer should screen these and promote relevant findings.

Sources: Traditional Medicinal Plants Used for Cancer Treatment in Sub-Saharan Africa: A Systematic Review. (2026) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/42357155); Climate-driven habitat shifts And niche overlap of overexploited trees Cordia africana Lam. and Terminalia brownii Fresen in Ethiopia. (2025) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/41469786); Ethnobotanical study of wild edible plants in Karamara forest patches, Eastern Ethiopia. (2025) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/41214764); Ethnobotanical study of medicinal plants and their threats in Yeki district, Southwestern Ethiopia. (2024) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/39709441); Plants used for the management of venereal diseases in sub-Saharan Africa: a systematic review and critical assessment of their research status. (2024) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/39726056); Ethnobotanical investigation of medicinal plants utilized by indigenous communities in the Fofa and Toaba sub-districts of the Yem Zone, Central Ethiopian Region. (2025) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/40045312); Plant species diversity, plant use, and classification of agroforestry homegardens in southern and southwestern Ethiopia. (2023) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/37287606); Ethnobotanical investigation of medicinal plants in Buska Mountain range, Hamar district, Southwestern Ethiopia. (2022) (https://europepmc.org/article/MED/36123732)

Legal compliance is part of sustainable collection (general; applies: any wild collection; review: awaiting expert review)

Voluntary standards treat legal compliance at local, national and international level as a precondition.

Next: List the authorisations your collection needs and attach them to the passport.

Sources: FairWild Standard: Version 3.0 (approved 19 December 2023) (https://www.fairwild.org/s/FairWildStandard-V3-FINAL.pdf)

Customary rights and benefit sharing (general; applies: any wild collection; review: awaiting expert review)

Collection should respect collectors' and communities' customary rights and share benefits fairly.

Next: Record how consent and benefit sharing were agreed with the community that holds rights to the site.

Sources: FairWild Standard: Version 3.0 (approved 19 December 2023) (https://www.fairwild.org/s/FairWildStandard-V3-FINAL.pdf)

Collection and post-harvest quality practice (general; applies: any wild collection; review: awaiting expert review)

GACP guidance covers identification, collection practice, drying, storage and documentation of herbal starting materials.

Next: Keep identification, drying and storage records per lot; ask the buyer which GACP expectations apply.

Sources: WHO guidelines on good agricultural and collection practices (GACP) for medicinal plants (2003) (https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9241546271); EMA Guideline on Good Agricultural and Collection Practice (GACP) for starting materials of herbal origin (EMEA/HMPC/246816/2005; Revision 1 adopted by HMPC in 2025) (https://www.ema.europa.eu/system/files/documents/scientific-guideline/hmpc-guideline-gacp-may-2025_en.pdf)

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